



The Language **GAZETTE**

"Language is the road map of a culture. It tells you where its people come from and where they are going." – Rita Mae Brown



Editor

Mr. Soham Kakade

Designed by

Jui Paranjape & Omkar Dhuraji

Sub-editor

Ms. Jui Paranjape

Marketing & Commercials

The Davandi Social Media Marketing services

Proofreader

Mrs. Sukhada Kakade Bhalerao

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HAPPY **INTERNATIONAL** *Translation day*



***"Translation is not a matter of words only: it is a matter of
making intelligible a whole culture."***

-Anthony Burgess

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In TLG's last editorial, I listed down reasons as to why Human Translation will be around, and AI or MT (Machine Translation) shall not replace it completely. Since Machine Translation seems to be the buzz word, let's dive deep and see how and why a freelance translator should leverage the technology and not fight with it. A collaborative approach shall yield results beyond expectation in a timely manner. It shall also overcome project management hassles to a great extent.

A collaborative approach to translation will effectively combine the strengths of both machine translation (MT) and human translation (HT) to enhance the overall quality, speed, and efficiency of the translation process. Here's an elaboration on how this collaboration works and its advantages.

1. Human-in-the-Loop Systems

This method integrates human translators into the machine translation workflow. After MT generates an initial draft, human translators review and refine the text. This process, known as post-editing, allows for corrections of errors and adjustments to ensure that the final output meets quality standards.

2. Translation Management Systems (TMS)

TMS platforms facilitate collaboration among teams by providing tools for real-time sharing of resources, terminology management, and project tracking. These systems help maintain consistency across translations and streamline communication among translators, editors, and project managers.

3. Translation Memory (TM) Tools

TM tools store previously translated segments, allowing translators to reuse phrases and terms across projects. This not only saves time but also ensures consistency in terminology and style, particularly for large projects or ongoing content updates.

Advantages of Collaborative Translation

Enhanced Quality

While MT can quickly generate translations, it often lacks the nuance and contextual understanding that human translators provide. By combining MT with HT, organizations can achieve a higher quality output that accurately reflects the intended meaning and tone of the original text.

2. Increased Efficiency

The collaborative approach allows for faster turnaround times as machines handle repetitive tasks while humans focus on refining complex or sensitive content. This division of labor maximizes productivity without sacrificing quality.

3. Cost-Effectiveness

Using MT for initial drafts reduces costs associated with human translation. Organizations can allocate resources more efficiently by reserving human expertise for high-priority or nuanced content while relying on MT for simpler tasks.

4. Flexibility in Project Management

Collaborative translation enables teams to adapt to varying project requirements. For instance, when dealing with large volumes of content that need quick translations, MT can handle the bulk work while humans ensure that critical documents are meticulously translated

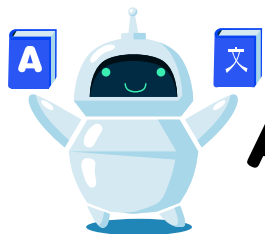
5. Cultural Sensitivity and Contextual Accuracy

Human translators bring cultural insights and contextual understanding that are crucial for effective communication across languages. This aspect is particularly important in marketing materials, legal documents, or any content where misinterpretation could lead to significant issues

Conclusion:

The collaborative approach to translation effectively leverages the strengths of both machine and human capabilities. By integrating MT with human oversight through systems like TMS and TM tools, organizations can achieve a balance between speed, cost-efficiency, and high-quality translations. This hybrid model not only enhances productivity but also ensures that translations resonate well with target audiences by maintaining cultural relevance and contextual accuracy.

[Visit our August Issue](#)



ARTIGO EXPERIÊNCIA DE TRADUÇÃO ABOT

Experiências em Tradução

Como tradutora e intérprete haitiana / francesa e espanhola com 5 anos de experiência, minha jornada na tradução tem sido desafiadora e gratificante. Especializado em tradução médica, jurídica e educacional, tive a oportunidade de trabalhar em projetos que exigem precisão, sensibilidade cultural e um profundo conhecimento dos idiomas de origem e destino.

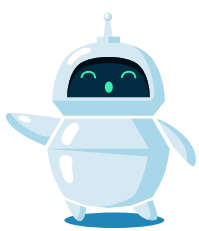
Começando a jornada

Minha jornada de tradução começou com um forte interesse em idiomas e um desejo de preencher as lacunas de comunicação entre as pessoas. Quando comecei, rapidamente percebi que a tradução não se trata apenas de converter palavras de um idioma para outro, mas de transmitir significado, contexto e emoção com precisão, respeitando as nuances culturais. Isso é particularmente importante em áreas como tradução médica e jurídica, onde uma pequena interpretação errônea pode ter consequências significativas.

Tradução médica: equilibrando precisão e sensibilidade

Na tradução médica, a chave é a precisão. A terminologia médica pode ser complexa e garantir que os termos sejam traduzidos corretamente enquanto permanecem acessíveis ao leitor é um desafio. Uma experiência memorável foi trabalhar em um conjunto de materiais de educação do paciente, onde tive que encontrar um equilíbrio entre usar termos médicos precisos e garantir que as informações fossem claras para pacientes sem formação médica. Eu também tinha que estar atento às diferenças culturais ao traduzir instruções para procedimentos médicos. Por exemplo, uma tradução que funcionou bem para pacientes haitianos pode não ser apropriada para pacientes portugueses devido a diferenças nos sistemas e práticas de saúde.





Tradução jurídica: atenção aos detalhes e confidencialidade

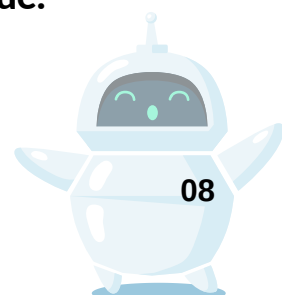
A tradução jurídica, por outro lado, requer uma atenção meticulosa aos detalhes. Os documentos jurídicos geralmente têm estruturas rígidas e terminologia específica, e o tradutor deve garantir que o significado de cada termo seja preservado. Ao longo dos anos, trabalhei em contratos, documentos judiciais e até certidões de nascimento. Cada projeto exigia que eu mantivesse a confidencialidade e garantisse que as traduções fossem legalmente precisas. Uma experiência que se destaca é quando traduzi um contrato jurídico para um cliente internacional. O desafio não era apenas entender o jargão jurídico, mas também garantir que os termos estivessem em conformidade com o direito espanhol e internacional. Foi uma tarefa complexa, mas me ensinou a importância do conhecimento jurídico transcultural na tradução.

Tradução Educacional: Adaptando-se a Diversos Públicos

A tradução educacional é talvez a área mais diversificada em que trabalho. Envolve a tradução de materiais como livros didáticos, trabalhos acadêmicos e cursos de e-learning. O desafio aqui é adaptar a linguagem para atender a uma ampla gama de públicos, desde jovens estudantes até profissionais acadêmicos. Em um projeto, traduzi um módulo inteiro de e-learning para um curso de treinamento voltado para profissionais de saúde. Isso envolveu não apenas traduzir o conteúdo, mas também adaptá-lo ao nível educacional e ao contexto cultural dos alunos. Eu tive que garantir que o conteúdo permanecesse envolvente e fácil de entender, ao mesmo tempo em que era preciso e informativo.

Ferramentas do comércio

Para agilizar meu trabalho, conto com várias ferramentas de tradução, incluindo MemoQ, Phrase, Trados, Smart cat, Word e Excel. Essas ferramentas me ajudaram a melhorar a precisão e a eficiência de minhas traduções, permitindo que eu gerencie projetos maiores, mantendo altos padrões de qualidade.



Reflexão sobre a jornada

Olhando para trás, minhas experiências em tradução moldaram meu crescimento profissional e pessoal. Cada projeto, seja médico, jurídico ou educacional, me ensinou a importância da precisão, consciência cultural e adaptabilidade. A tradução não se trata apenas de transferir palavras de um idioma para outro, mas de criar conexões, promover a compreensão e unir culturas.

Estou ansioso para continuar essa jornada, assumindo novos desafios e aprofundando minha experiência em tradução

English Translation on next page





ARTICLE ABOUT TRANSLATION EXPERIENCE

Experiences in Translation

As a Haitian / French and Spanish translator and interpreter with 5 years of experience, my journey in translation has been both challenging and rewarding. Specializing in medical, legal, and educational translation, I have had the opportunity to work on projects that require precision, cultural sensitivity, and a deep understanding of both source and target languages.

Beginning the Journey

My translation journey began with a strong interest in languages and a desire to bridge communication gaps between people. When I started, I quickly realized that translation is not just about converting words from one language to another—it's about conveying meaning, context, and emotion accurately while respecting cultural nuances. This is particularly important in fields like medical and legal translation, where a slight misinterpretation can have significant consequences.

Medical Translation: Balancing Accuracy and Sensitivity

In medical translation, the key is precision. Medical terminology can be complex and ensuring that terms are translated correctly while remaining accessible to the reader is a challenge. One memorable experience was working on a set of patient education materials, where I had to find a balance between using accurate medical terms and ensuring that the information was clear for patients without a medical background. I also had to be mindful of cultural differences when translating instructions for medical procedures. For example, a translation that worked well for Haitian patients might not be appropriate for Portuguese patients due to differences in healthcare systems and practices.



Legal Translation: Attention to Detail and Confidentiality

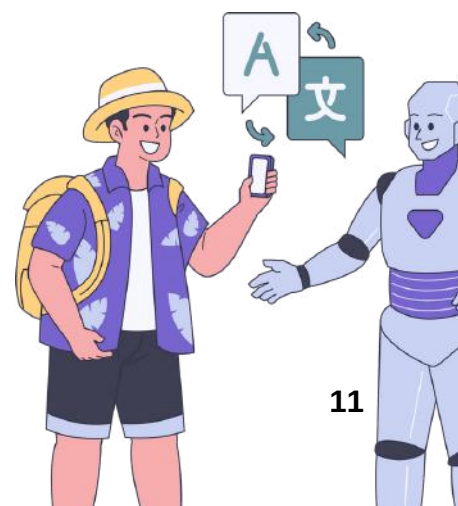
Legal translation, on the other hand, requires a meticulous attention to detail. Legal documents often have rigid structures and specific terminology, and the translator must ensure that the meaning of every term is preserved. Over the years, I have worked on contracts, court documents, and even birth certificates. Each project required me to maintain confidentiality and ensure that the translations were legally accurate. One experience that stands out is when I translated a legal contract for an international client. The challenge was not only in understanding the legal jargon but also in ensuring that the terms complied with both Spanish and international law. It was a complex task, but it taught me the importance of cross-cultural legal knowledge in translation.

Educational Translation: Adapting to Diverse Audiences

Educational translation is perhaps the most diverse area I work in. It involves translating materials such as textbooks, academic papers, and e-learning courses. The challenge here is to adapt the language to suit a wide range of audiences, from young students to academic professionals. In one project, I translated an entire e-learning module for a training course aimed at healthcare workers. This involved not only translating the content but also adapting it to the educational level and cultural context of the learners. I had to ensure that the content remained engaging and easy to understand while still being accurate and informative.

Tools of the Trade

To streamline my work, I rely on several translation tools, including MemoQ, Phrase, Trados, Smart cat, Word, and Excel. These tools have helped me improve the accuracy and efficiency of my translations, allowing me to manage larger projects while maintaining high standards of quality.



Reflection on the Journey

Looking back, my experiences in translation have shaped my professional and personal growth. Each project, whether medical, legal, or educational, has taught me the importance of precision, cultural awareness, and adaptability. Translation is not just about transferring words from one language to another—it's about creating connections, fostering understanding, and bridging cultures.

I look forward to continuing this journey, taking on new challenges, and deepening my expertise in translation.

-Mr.Karl de Ronne Casseus
publication@ewan.co.in





Un Maratí Director de Ministerio de Agricultura de México:

UN CUENTO FASCINANTE DE DOCTOR KHANKHOJE

Nacido el 7 de Noviembre de 1884, Khankhoje hizo su educación primaria y secundaria en Wardha, Maharashtra. Más tarde , como parte de la guerra de independencia de la India, formó Gadar Party en Estados Unidos.

En 1920, Sr. Pandurang se mudó a México y se desempeñó como maestro de la Escuela Nacional de Agricultura, científico genetista, director de las Escuelas Libres de Agricultura, técnico y asesor del gobierno federal y distintos gobiernos estatales, y empleado del naciente sector agro-industrial en el país.

Khankhoje inventó un nuevo especie de maíz en 1928. Él ganó tanta fama que Diego Rivera dedicó un cuadro presentándolo a Sr. Khankhoje. Era parte de la época de pre Revolución Verde de México. Se desveló su estatua fuera de Escuela Nacional de Agricultura (Universidad Autónoma Chapingo en realidad)



English Translation on next page

A Marathi Director to the Agricultural Ministry of Mexico:

A FASCINATING TALE OF DOCTOR KHANKHOJE

Born on November 7, 1884, Khankhoje did his primary and secondary education in Wardha, Maharashtra. Later, as part of India's war of independence, he formed Gadar Party in the United States.

In 1920, Mr. Pandurang moved to Mexico and served as a teacher at the National School of Agriculture, geneticist scientist, director of the School of Agriculture, expert and adviser to the federal government and various state governments, and employee of the emerging agro-industrial sector of the country.

Khankhoje invented a new species of corn in 1928. He gained so much fame that Diego Rivera dedicated a painting presenting Mr. Khankhoje. He was part of the pre-Green Revolution era of Mexico. His statue was unveiled outside the National School of Agriculture (Universidad Autónoma Chapingo actually)



-Mr Rahul Sahasrabuddhe
publication@ewan.co.in



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Malshej Ghat

WHERE ROADS MEET SKY

There's something magical about riding through the winding roads of Maharashtra, where the landscape transforms into a living canvas of green. Recently, I had the pleasure of experiencing this magic on my Bajaj Dominar 400, along with my riding community, Nomadic Explorers Pune. Our destination: the breathtaking Malshej Ghat, a place where the roads seem to meet the sky.

The Journey Begins

We started our ride early in the morning from Pune, engines roaring with excitement. The journey to Malshej Ghat, roughly 125 km one way, is an adventure in itself. The road, flanked by lush greenery, seemed to invite us into the heart of nature. As we rode, the city's hustle faded, replaced by the tranquil rhythm of the countryside. The Dominar 400, with its powerful engine and comfortable handling, made every twist and turn a joy to navigate.

The Majesty of Malshej Ghat

As we neared Malshej Ghat, the landscape began to change. The hills rose around us, draped in a thick blanket of mist, as if the mountains were guarding a hidden paradise. Malshej Ghat, often hailed as the heaven of Maharashtra, is truly a sight to behold. Waterfalls cascade down the cliffs, their waters mingling with the clouds, creating an ethereal atmosphere. The view from the top, where the road seems to merge with the sky, is nothing short of awe-inspiring.

Riding through Malshej Ghat during the rainy season is an experience beyond words. The rain-kissed roads, the cool breeze carrying the scent of wet earth, and the mist that hugs the mountains create a sensory overload of serenity. Every curve of the road reveals a new facet of nature's beauty, and every drop of rain adds to the exhilaration of the ride.

Riding with Nomadic Explorers Pune

Sharing this journey with Nomadic Explorers Pune made it all the more special. Our community is not just about riding; it's about exploring, experiencing, and connecting with the world around us. Riding together, we formed a symphony of engines, each one a note in the melody of our adventure. The camaraderie, the shared joy of discovery, and the collective appreciation of nature's wonders made the experience unforgettable.

-Mr Saurabh Laghate
publication@ewan.co.in

勤勉" は成功への道

日本語の翻訳者/通訳者として働いているギータです。日本人や日本企業について自分の考えを述べたいとおもいます。

日本人及びインド人に対して8月15日は歴史深い日にちです。

日本は1945年8月15日に降伏しましたが、インドは二年後1947年8月15日に独立しました。

インド人のラダビノード・パールは日本の戦争犯罪を裁いた東京裁判（極東国際軍事法廷）の11人の判事団にインド代表としてくわわった人物です。（詳細はパール判決書）。1949年、平和の象徴として、アジアゾウ「インディラ」（メス）の寄贈を受けました。1952年4月28日、日本とインドは外交関係を樹立する書簡を取り交わしました。

インド大使館は、東京都の歴史的かつ政治的に重要な場所である千代田区の九段下に位置し、大使館の前には皇居と緑のたっぷり千鳥ヶ淵堀があり、道路の向側に有名な靖国神社があります。

第二次世界大戦で無条件降伏したことにもかかわらず、日本は30年以内に経済大国の一つになってしまい、インドは今も発展途上国に見られています。

なぜそうなっているのですよか？

理由の一つとして以下も考えられます。

第二次世界大戦で無条件降伏した日本人は屈辱を感じ面目を保つために荒廃した国を元に戻すという目的で懸命に働きました。改善などのような体系的なアプローチかつ高い質を合言葉に彼らは企業の成長を国の安定成長と成功に結び付けることに努め、日本を高品質製品のブランドアンバサダーにしました。まあ、日本はそれを達成できたのは彼らの性格も一つの理由だからだ。素直に学び、学んだものをそのまま仕事の現場で取り入り、後輩にそのまま教えるという習慣は日本がリーダでありつづけ原動力になっているのです。日本の企業は研究開発に時間と資金を投資し、世界クラスの製品を作りつづけています。

現在のインドは？

インド人の授業員は最初素直に仕事を覚え、教えられた通りに一生懸命に働きます。仕事になれてくると、より早く、場合によってより良い方法で仕事を終えるための自分なりの方法を見つけ、アシスタントや新社員に仕事の自分のやり方を教えてしまい、これが繰り返され、社内で不整合や品質の問題が発生し、利用者の信頼喪失にもつながります。残念ながら、インド企業では現在も研究開発に多くの時



間や資金を投資していません。

インドの日系企業で働いていると、授業員が仕事上のミスに対して小学生のような言い訳をするのを見ていつも気分が悪くなります。

インド人は、仕事を生計を立てるための一つの手段としてしか考えるのでなく、自分の仕事に誇りをもって胸を張って働く姿を見たいです。

次回はインド人の考え方や仕事のやり方が成功していることについて話したいと思います。

English translation on next page

Commitment

THE WAY TO SUCCESS

Being a Japanese translator and interpreter I have been involved with the Japanese and Japanese companies for 20 years and would like to put in my observations. We all know that the Japan lost the second world war very badly, but bounced back to become the world's second most prosperous nation in a time period of 50 years.

How many of us know that India and Japan had a rebirth at around the same time. Japan surrendered on August 15, 1945 and India got its independence on August 15, 1947.

When Japan was isolated as a pariah after the war, first it was an Indian called Radha Binod Pal who spoke for Japan as a member of the tribunal of Judges officiating at the Tokyo trials in 1946. After Independence India was also the first country to sign a peace treaty with Japan, and an elephant was gifted to Japan by India in 1949. Any wonder that Indian Embassy in Japan is situated in the heart of Japan in front of the Palace grounds and Chidorigafuji, one of the most beautiful parks in Japan and opposite to the very famous Yasukuni Jinja the seat of power of the time.

That is a lot of water under the bridge now. Although both the countries started rebuilding their respective countries at the same time, India is still a developing nation where Japan is a highly developed nation.

What can be the reason for this?

Any nation is made up of its people.

The Japanese knew the only way they can save their face after the humiliating defeat in the war is by bouncing back to become one of consequence. For this they not only worked hard but created

formulas to reflect their hard work in quality and turning it into success.

Their mantra was obedience and acceptance of knowledge in the work place without question. This attitude allowed their businesses to thrive and created manufacturing and trading giants which carried their employees along with them to greater heights, bettered their standard of living and made their governments sit on a great pile of wealth.

Why could India not achieve this?

Earlier I had said that Japanese were obedient. They always bowed down to the authority, intelligence and experience and obey them verbatim. It is the same in their place of work. They do their work perfectly the way they are taught when they joined and teach the same to their juniors thus continuing the legacy with the new comers. This attitude and the time and money spent on R and D by the company has made them the most dependable and trustworthy manufacturers in the world today.

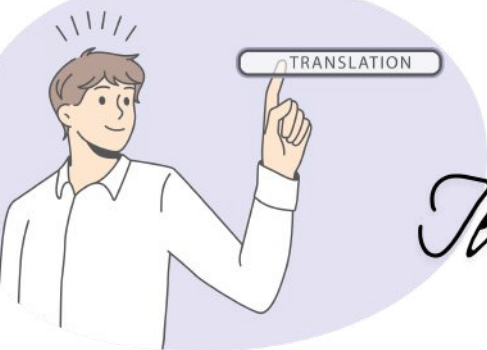
On the contrary we Indians learn from our superiors with obedience, but start our own way of working after some experience which again is repeated by the juniors down the line. Thus, consistency is not there and we spend a lot of time in finding the cause of issue after it happens.

Added to this the management also does not want to spend time or money on R and D which makes us a country always improvising according to the need. Thus, our product quality goes down, neither giving our products an edge nor gaining the trust of the consumers.

As an interpreter in Japanese manufacturing companies in India, I always see ourselves cutting a sorry figure in front of the Japanese, explaining our stand with excuses for what went wrong, why a particular process was not followed etc. Although we have learnt and understood what should be done, we cut corners, take shortcuts because of lack of time or

-MS. Geeta San
publication@ewan.co.in





The Art of Bridging Cultures

MY JOURNEY IN TRANSLATION

Introduction

Translation is more than just a linguistic exercise; it's an art of bridging cultures, ideas, and experiences. My journey as a translator has been one of constant learning, adaptation, and exploration. Each project I take on teaches me something new, not just about language but about the nuances of human communication.

The Early Days

When I first started, I was focused solely on accuracy—ensuring that each word was translated correctly. But as I gained experience, I realized that translation is about much more than words; it's about context, tone, and intent. It's about conveying the same emotions and ideas that the original text aimed to express, even if it means diverging from a literal translation.

Challenges and Triumphs

One of the most challenging aspects of translation is dealing with cultural references. What is humorous or poignant in one culture may not translate well into another. Over time, I've learned to navigate these complexities by immersing myself in both the source and target cultures, understanding the subtleties that make each unique.

Lessons Learned

Through my work, I've come to appreciate the importance of empathy in translation. A translator must put themselves in the shoes of both the author and the reader. It's about balancing fidelity to the original text with the need to make the translation accessible and engaging for the target audience.

The Future of Translation

As the world becomes more interconnected, the role of translators is becoming increasingly vital. We are not just converting text from one language to another; we are enabling cross-cultural communication and understanding. The future of translation lies in embracing this responsibility and continuing to refine our craft.

Conclusion

My experiences in translation have taught me that it is as much an art as it is a science. It requires not only linguistic skills but also cultural insight, creativity, and a deep understanding of human nature. As we celebrate International Translation Day, I am reminded of the impact our work has on bringing the world closer together, one translation at a time.

-Mr. Ahmed Ashraf
publication@ewan.co.in





Word



Embark on a global journey with our word search puzzle featuring greetings in various languages. From “Hola” to “Merci,” find and learn how people around the world greet in their native tongues. Dive into a fun linguistic adventure and expand your cultural horizons, one word at a time!

B	Y	T	I	E	I	Z	A	R	G	Q
I	O	Q	X	I	E	X	I	E	A	R
E	M	O	D	S	P	N	J	Y	Y	I
N	A	E	N	C	A	N	T	A	D	O
V	J	Q	R	P	S	D	O	J	N	S
E	O	A	I	C	Q	I	H	U	J	N
N	J	Y	R	C	I	B	A	O	L	O
I	O	D	A	N	K	E	U	A	H	B
D	B	D	U	T	I	S	S	K	I	A
O	A	W	I	H	C	I	N	N	O	K

- MERCI
- GRAZIE
- XIE XIE
- HOLA
- KONNICHIWA
- BONSOIR
- CIAO
- BIENVENIDO
- DANKE
- ENCANTADO

Answers will be issued in next month's magazine



Barbe du Centenaire!

Depuis mercredi dernier, le village d'Azy possède un centenaire : M. Boquillon.

Monsieur Boquillon, malgré ses cent ans, est encore alerte. Il n'est jamais malade, il n'a pas d'infirmité, il a toutes ses dents sauf trois, et il a, comme on dit, bon pied bon œil !

En fait, il paraît plus jeune que son voisin, M. Gardet, un jeune homme de quatre-vingts ans, qui marche avec deux cannes. Quand il rencontre M. Gardet, il ne manque jamais de crier gaiement : « Bonjour jeune home. »

J'oubliais de dire que M Boquillon a une barbe, une magnifique barbe blanche.

Le jour de son centième anniversaire, vous pensez bien que qu'il y avait une grande réunion de la famille. Ses fils, leurs femmes, ses filles, leurs maris, leurs enfants, leurs petits-enfants et arrières petits-enfants, presque tous sont venus. Ils sont venus de Marseille, de Carpentras, de Nîmes, de Lyon, de Paris sans compter ceux qui habitent dans la région.

Ceux qui n'ont pas pu venir ont envoyé des télégrammes de félicitation.

En tout, ils étaient soixante-sept à table, ce jour-là. Plus une douzaine des invités. Plus mon oncle, ma tante, mes deux cousines et moi-même.

Il y avait un énorme gâteau avec quatre-vingt-dix-neuf petites bougies et une grosse bougie. M. Boquillon a soufflé la grosse bougie, et les plus jeunes des enfants ont soufflé les petites bougies.

On a bu du champagne à la santé du centenaire. On lui a souhaité un second siècle aussi heureux que le premier ! On a chanté des chansons, et à la fin les jeunes gens et les jeunes filles ont dansé.

C'est à ce moment que le petit Gilbert, qui a cinq ans, s'approche de M. Boquillon. Il contemple avec admiration sa belle barbe blanche.

« Grand papa, dit-il, grand papa, vous avez une très belle barbe »

M. Boquillon est flatté de cette admiration naïve. Il sourit et il caresse sa barbe.

« Grand papa, dit-il, quand je serai vieux, est-ce que j'aurai une aussi belle barbe que vous ? »

- Peut-être, dit M. Boquillon, peut-être ! Mais tu as encore le temps d'y penser, mon garçon .

- Grand papa, la nuit, quand vous dormez, est-ce que vous mettez votre barbe sur la couverture ou sous la couverture ?

M. Boquillon réfléchit un instant. Il finit par dire :

- Ma foi, je ne sais pas ! Je te dirai cela demain matin. »

Eh bien, vous me croirez si vous voulez, mais pour la première fois de sa vie, M. Boquillon a passé la nuit sans dormir !

Mettait-il d'habitude sa barbe sur la couverture ou sous la couverture ? C'est ce qu'il ne pouvait pas se rappeler.

Tantôt il la mettait sur la couverture, mais il avait froid ; tantôt il la mettait sous la couverture, mais il avait chaud et la barbe le chatouillait.

Il s'agitait, il se tournait et se retournait dans son lit. Le matin, il avait la fièvre, et il parlait de couper sa barbe !

Sa fille, la vieille Brigitte, est venue chercher mon oncle Antoine.

« Monsieur le docteur, dit-elle, mon père est malade. Il n'a pas dormi une minute cette nuit. J'entendais qu'il se tournait et se retournait dans son lit. Ce matin, il a la fièvre - j'ai pris sa température - il a 39° de fièvre. Et il parle de couper sa barbe ! »

« Ah, ah ! Dit mon oncle en entrant dans la chambre du malade. Qu'est-ce qui vous arrive, M. Boquillon ? Est-ce que c'est le champagne d'hier ?

- No docteur, gémit le centenaire. Ce n'est pas le champagne. C'est ma barbe.

Et il a expliqué l'histoire à mon oncle.

Mon oncle l'a écouté sans rire. Il a dit – Ce n'est rien. Vous allez pendre une tasse de lait chaud avec un comprimé d'aspirine, et vous allez vous coucher sur le côté droit. Voyez : comme cela votre barbe ne vous gêne pas. »

Dès le lendemain, M. Boquillon était guéri.

Mais il faut que je vous dise une chose. Hier j'étais à la mairie d'Azy avec mon oncle. Mon oncle cherchait une date dans le registre de l'état civil – c'est-à-dire dans le registre où l'on inscrit les naissances, les mariages et les décès. Par curiosité j'ai cherché la date de la naissance de M. Boquillon.

Savez-vous ? La famille Boquillon et M. Boquillon lui-même ont fait une erreur d'un an. Le centenaire n'a que quatre-vingt-dix-neuf ans !

« Nous ne le dirons à personne, a dit mon oncle. Cela leur ferait trop de peine. »

Et puis, quatre-vingt-dix-neuf ans, c'est déjà bien joli, ne trouvez-vous pas ?

Marathi Translation on next page



शतायुषी आजोबांची दाढी

मागच्या बुधवारपासून 'आझी' गावाचा उल्लेख शतायुषीचे गाव असा होतो आहे. आणि हे शतायुषी गृहस्थ आहेत श्री. बोकियाँ.

शंभरीत आले असले तरी बोकियाँ आजोबा तसे चपळच म्हटले पाहिजेत. ते कधी आजारी पडलेले नाहीत, त्यांना कोणत्याही प्रकारचे अपंगत्व नाही. तीन दात सोडले तर त्यांचे तोंडातले दंताजींचे ठाणे पक्के आहे. 'त्यांच्या नखातसुद्धा आजार नाही' असेच म्हणावे लागते.

आणि म्हणूनच त्यांना वाटते की त्यांचे ८४ वर्षांचे 'तरूण' शेजारी श्री गार्दे (ज्यांना चालतांना दोन काठ्या घ्याव्या लागतात) यांच्यापेक्षा आपण खूपच तरूण आहोत. आणि त्यामुळेच जेव्हा ते गार्दे आजोबांना भेटतात, तेव्हा ते प्रसन्नचित्ताने ओरडतात - 'नमस्कार तरूण मित्रा'...

अरेच्या, मी तुम्हाला सांगायचेच विसरलो की बोकियाँ आजोबांना दाढी आहे - पांढरीशुभ्र, लांबलचक दाढी.

आणि तुम्हाला वाटले तसेच झाले..त्यांच्या वाढदिवशी त्यांच्या घरी एक खूप मोठे कौटुंबिक संमेलनच झाले. त्यांचे मुलगे अन् त्यांच्या बायका ; त्यांच्या मुली अन् त्यांचे पती ; त्या सर्वांची मुले, नातवंडे, पतवंडे असे बहुतेक सर्वजण आले होते. मार्सेय्, कार्पात्रास्, नीम्स्, लियोँ, पॅरिस अशा सर्व गावांतून अन् त्यांच्या आजूबाजूच्या गावातलेपण सगळे आले होते.

याशिवाय जे काणी येऊ शकले नाहीत त्यांनी शुभेच्छादर्शक तारा पाठवल्या होत्या.

त्या दिवशी जेवणाच्या टेबलाशी एकंदर सदुसष्ट मंडळी होती..अन् शिवाय दहा-बारा निमंत्रित..

आणखी शिवाय माझे काका, काकू, दोन चुलतबहिणी आणि मी स्वतः !

त्यांच्या तेथे त्यादिवशी नवव्याणव छोट्या मेणबत्त्यांथे एक मोठी मेणबत्ती लावलेली एक भलीमोठी केक ठेवली होती. बोकियाँ आजोबांनी मोठी मेणबत्ती फुंकली व हजर असलेल्या सर्व चिल्ल्यापिल्ल्यांनी सगळ्या छोट्या मेणबत्त्या फुंकल्या.

सर्वांनी आजोबांना शुभेच्छा देत थोडी थोडी शॉपेन प्राशन केली. त्यांना त्यांच्या आयुष्याचे दुसरे शतकही पहिल्या शतका इतकेच चांगले जावो अशा शुभकामनापण व्यक्त केल्या गेल्या. कोणी गाणीही म्हटली आणि शेवटी उपस्थितांतील तरूण तरुणींनी नृत्यही केले.

आणि त्याच वेळेला पाच वर्षे वयाचा गिल्बर्ट आजोबांजवळ जाऊन त्यांच्या सुंदर पांढ-याशुभ्र दाढीचे कौतुक करू लागला.

« आजोबा », तो म्हणाला, « आजोबा, तुमची दाढी किती सुंदर आहे हो ! »

त्या अत्यंत निष्कपटपणे केल्या गेलेल्या प्रशंसेमुळे बोकियाँ आजोबा सुखावले आणि स्मितहास्य करीत त्यांनी आपली दाढी कुरवाळली.

« आजोबा », तो म्हणाला, « जेव्हा मी म्हातारा होईन तेव्हा माझी दाढीपण तुमच्याइतकीच सुंदर असेल का हो ? »

- «कदाचित्,» आजोबा म्हणाले, «कदाचित्. पण बाळा, त्याबद्दल विचार करायला तुला खूप अवकाश आहे रे »

- «आजोबा...रात्री जेव्हा तुम्ही झोपता ना, तेव्हा तुम्ही तुमची दाढी पांघरुणाच्या आत ठेवता की बाहेर ठेवता ? »

बोकियाँ आजोबांनी क्षणभर विचार केला अन् ते म्हणाले - «खरं सांगू का, मला ठाऊक नाही. त्याबद्दल मी तुला उद्या सकाळी सांगेन. »

हं...वाटले तुम्हाला तर माझ्यावर विश्वास ठेवा, पण « रात्रभर मुळीच डोळ्याला डोळा लागला नाही नाही » अशी घटना बोकियाँ आजोबांच्या आयुष्यात पहिल्यांदाच घडत होती !

खरच, काय बरे होती त्यांची सवय...दाढी पांघरुणाच्या आत ठेवायची की बाहेर ठेवायची ? त्यांना ते आठवणे अशक्य झाले होते.

कधी ते दाढी पांघरुणाच्या वर ठेवीत पण त्यांना थंडी वाजे, कधी ते जाढी पांघरुणाच्या आत ठेवीत पण त्यांना उकडे असे व दाढीमुळे त्यांना गुदगुल्याही होत.

त्यांची चुळबूळ चालू होती व अंथरुणावरच या कुशीवरून त्या कुशीवर ते सारखे वळत होते. सकाळी त्यांना ताप भरला व त्यांनी दाढी कापून टाकायची असे सांगून टाकले.

त्यांची वयस्क मुलगी ब्रिजित् आंतुआन् काकाला - तो डॉक्टर होता ना - बोलवायला आली होती.

-« डॉक्टर डॉक्टर, बाबांना बरे नाही आहे. काल रात्री त्यांचा मिनिटभरही डोळा लागलेला नाही. रात्रभर मला त्यांची चुळबूळ चाललेली ऐकू येत होती व अंथरुणावरच या कुशीवरून त्या कुशीवर ते सारखे वळत होते. अन् सकाळी त्यांना ताप आला. मी पाहिला ... चांगला ३९° होता. आणि ते म्हणत होते - दाढी कापून टाकायची »

- अं अं ...पेशंटच्या खोलीत शिरताशिरता माझा काका म्हणाला... मि. बोकियाँ, काय होते आहे हो तुम्हाला ? का कालच्या शॅपेनचा परिणाम आहे हा !

- नाही हो, आजोबा कुरकुरले, शॅपेनचा नव्हे, माझ्या दाढीचा परिणाम आहे हा !

....आणि मग त्यांनी डॉक्टरांना सर्व कहाणी सांगितली.

हसू येऊ न देता डॉक्टरांना ती सर्व कहाणी शांतपणे ऐकून घेतली. ते म्हणाले - « काही काळजी करू नका... एक कपभर गरम दुधाबरोबर ही अँस्पिरिनची गोळी घ्या अन् उजव्या कुशीवर झोपा.

अन् मग पहा तुमची ही दाढी तुम्हाला मुळीच त्रास देणार नाही. »

दुस-या दिवसापासून बोकियाँ आजोबांची प्रकृति सुधारली.

पण मला तुम्हाला एक गोष्ट सांगायलाच हवी. कालच मी काकाबरोबर आझी म्युनिसिपालिटीच्या कचेरीत गेलो होतो. काकाला तिथल्या दफ्तरातली एक तारीख शोधायची होती. म्हणजे तिथल्या जन्म-विवाह-मृत्यू नोंद दफ्तरातली. उत्सुकतेपोटी मी बोकियाँ आजोबांची जन्मतारीख शोधली. तुम्हाला माहिती आहे का ? सर्व बोकियाँ कुटुंबियांनी व स्वतः बोकियाँ आजोबांनीसुद्धा एक वर्षाची चूक केली होती. शतायुषी म्हणवणारे बोकियाँ आजोबा फक्त नव्व्याणव वर्षाचेच झाले होते !
« आपण नको हे कोणाला सांगायला » काका म्हणाला « त्यामुळे त्यांना खूप त्रास होईल »
पण का हो , नव्व्याणव वर्षाचे आयुष्यही किती सुंदर असे तुम्हाला नाही का वाटत ?



-Mr. Ravindra Abhyankar
publication@ewan.co.in



Verbal VOYAGES

ANSWERS

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1. SPANISH

**I'M ALWAYS IN A HURRY, BUT I'M NOT A CAR.
I CAN MAKE YOU LAUGH, BUT I'M NOT A STAR.
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Rápido

2. FRENCH

**I'M A PASTRY THAT'S FLAKY, BUT I'M NOT A FISH.
YOU'LL FIND ME IN A CAFÉ, IF YOU MAKE A WISH.
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Croissant

3. GERMAN

**I'M A TYPE OF CHEESE THAT'S ALWAYS IN A RUSH,
WHEN YOU ASK ME TO SLOW DOWN, I SAY, "DON'T FUSS!"
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Brie



4. ITALIAN

**I'M A TYPE OF PASTA THAT'S NEVER IN A BIND,
WHEN YOU ASK ME TO RELAX, I SAY, "TAKE YOUR TIME!"
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Fusilli



5. CHINESE

**I'M A DISH THAT'S SERVED WITH A SIDE OF FUN,
I CAN BE SPICY OR SWEET, BUT I'M ALWAYS NUMBER ONE.
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Wonton

6. JAPANESE

**I'M A TYPE OF FISH THAT SWIMS WITH DELIGHT,
WHEN YOU CATCH ME, I'M A REAL SUSHI SIGHT.
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Tuna

7. RUSSIAN

**I'M A DRINK THAT'S STRONG, BUT I'M NOT A FIGHT,
I'LL WARM YOU UP ON A COLD WINTER NIGHT.
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Vodka

8. PORTUGUESE

**I'M A FRUIT THAT'S JUICY, BUT I'M NOT A PEAR,
I'M OFTEN IN A DRINK, BUT I'M NOT A FLARE.
WHAT AM I?**

Answer: Limonada





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This month's Vendor Requirements

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- 2. Korean, Uzbek, Russian Translators**
- 3. Indonesian, Tamil, Arabic Voice-over Artists**



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Dear Readers, Contributors, and Supporters,

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to each of you for being a crucial part of our language gazette journey. Your passion for languages, coupled with your unwavering support, has made our issue a celebration of linguistic diversity and cultural richness.

To our dedicated contributors, thank you for sharing your insights, knowledge, and stories with our global community. Your contributions have illuminated countless aspects of language learning, linguistics, and cultural exploration.

To our valued readers, thank you for joining us on this enriching adventure. Your enthusiasm and engagement inspire us to continue bringing you high-quality content that celebrates the beauty and complexity of languages worldwide.

We look forward to continuing this journey with you, exploring new linguistic horizons, and fostering a deeper understanding and appreciation of languages and cultures from around the globe.

**Warm regards,
The Language Gazette Team**

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